

The design of individual applications is kept within the familiar layout that people have grown used to over the years. The layering of toolbars isn't in tabs, but in sliding control panels which can be side scrolled to find the required tool. The inclusion of a variety of templates and designs for different file types such as presentation and charts allows for a diverse means to express ideas and data, which is of special note considering that the suite is available for free.

Kingsoft Office Basic

The Kingsoft Office productivity suite, also known as 'KSO' or 'KSOOffice', is a set of applications originally developed in 1988 in China. The official software package of the office suite was only formalised in 2001 with the release of WPS Office in 2001 when it became commercially available to the Chinese enterprise market. It is currently available as Kingsoft Office Free-ware 2013 or KSOOffice 2013 and includes the key applications of 'Kingsoft Writer' (word processing), 'Kingsoft Spreadsheets' and 'Kingsoft Presentation'. The Pro version of the software is available with all the professionally required enterprise features while the Basic version is completely free and enough for casual everyday usage.

Kingsoft is one the largest China-based software development firms with a long tradition of focusing on development for the internet and



The Kingsoft office suite

the Microsoft Windows operating system. But the evolving nature of the internet and alternative operating systems, especially Android OS, has compelled Kingsoft to port its office productivity suite to Linux, iOS and Android OSes as well. One of Kingsoft's

key areas of specialisation is development for mobile platforms, and it brings that value to its office suite as it's one of the most popular mobile-based office suites in Asia.

Unlike most of the other free-to-use office suites we've discussed so far, Kingsoft Office is proprietary software instead of being a product of the open source movement. But despite its corporate origins, it has been made